Us] resolutely stitch threads of various extraliterary discourses in the poetic."[28] While Reagan's trip to Germany sought to reaffirm U.S. global power through calls to memory and an extension of "I am a Berliner" identifications, Lorde's poetic explorations of diaspora in Berlin and elsewhere acknowledge difference as a meaningful source of identity; her work imagined or informed by divided Berlin also operates as a mode of interrogating U.S. empire and hegemonic notions of national authority by locating sites of diasporic consciousness that were also sites of U.S.-fueled conflict. In preparing to release *Our Dead Behind Us*, Lorde reflected on her own strained identification with Reagan in press interviews surrounding the project, as well as her need to relate. As she told West German journalists, "I cannot say I am black and so Ronald Reagan has nothing to do with me. … The personal and political are entwined; they are not the same, but they support each other."[29] Many of the book's poetic scenes occur in or refer to a litany of American Cold War hot spots and sites of grassroots activism: Germany, South Africa, and Grenada or within the United States at sites of racial, gender, sexual, and economic violence.

The book's title, based on a line of her opening poem "Sisters in Arms," is an invocation of memory and forges a language of shared belonging. She does not attempt to distance herself from the "dead" to whom she refers but, rather, create space for memorialization and collectivization.[30] Further, the "us" in the title *Our Dead Behind Us* conjures multiple potential meanings. The title announces a call for collectivization but marks division and difference as the ground for solidarity. The "us" could also stand in for "U.S." and refer to Lorde's own wrestling with her identity as American at a moment of Cold War reacceleration, which she made public through alternate, lowercase spellings of "america."[31] In this sense, Lorde's poetic approach bridges the geopolitics of the Cold War and memorial culture—just as Reagan did at Bitburg—but in ways that allow diasporic consciousness to be forged across lines of difference, with poetry enacting open-ended reflection instead of closure. As Lorde writes in a poem in *Our Dead Behind Us*, "Home," she follows a path to seek out meaningful spaces of mourning and belonging. Grenada is conjured as "her mother's island," and in the poem she weighs kinship through and beyond a "name in the stone." She seeks connections that live beyond violence and disruption of military conquest, as well as state-sponsored and traditional forms of memorialization. Adding a purposeful spatial pause, a signature of Lorde's